



The TCP/IP window



Setting the IP using Telnet

In the Start Menu, select run and type in "telnet <default IP value>", where <default IP value> represents the factory, default IP address you've reverted the printer to by using the Reset switch.

You will be presented with a

disabling the IP means you won't be able to assign one.

Steps For A Non-Network Printer

If you have a laser printer that isn't network-ready, that is, if it doesn't have a LAN jack, you will

need to set up a print server. This is a device that has a LAN jack on one side, and connectivity options to one or more printers on the other side. Typically, print servers will have a combination of parallel and USB ports—usually not more than three ports. This "print server" is not to be mistaken with a PC working as a print server.

Also notice that most of the options (including setting an IP) will have an Enable and Disable option. Setting any of the options to Disable will mean that the option itself is disabled, so

telnet window. Here you can change the IP address to whatever value you wish to assign. The SM can also be set here.

1. Set up the print server, hook it up to the LAN, and connect it to the laser printer, either through the parallel or the USB port.

2. Next, you need to install the print server software on any one PC on the network. This is the software that will find the print server. Once again, in the case of a large network, all the print servers from the manufacturer bundling the software will be listed, and you will have to select the one you want to configure.

3. Now you assign an IP and then an SM to the print server, similar to the case of the network printer.

4. The next step will be to assign a virtual port to the printer connected to the print server. Virtual ports are basically multiple ports that share one physical port: the physical path to each of the printers connected to the spooler is the same. This is because a print server can connect to multiple printers, but it has only one IP address. It therefore can share this IP with multiple printers using virtual ports. Each printer will get a virtual port and therefore a virtual IP.

5. Next, a port on the computer has to be assigned to the print server (and not the printer, since it doesn't have a physical IP).

Your laser printer is ready to be used over the network! ■

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Usage Tips

Laser printers were earlier the prerogative of corporates and small businesses. A drastic fall in prices has made them affordable to SoHo and home users as well. The major advantages of a laser printer are low running costs, suitability for volume printing, and the fact that they are much faster than inkjets.

□ In case of heavy usage, make sure you invest in a printer that has a separate toner cartridge and drum: this reduces long-term running costs.

□ Your laser printer generates a lot of heat, especially when used non-stop for extended periods of time. Make sure to place it away from obstructions, preferably near an AC vent, so as to enable proper heat dissipation, which will increase longevity.

□ Laser printers consume much more power than inkjets; make sure the printer is in standby mode when it's not being used.

□ For mass printing, if quality is not an issue, use draft mode, since this uses a lot of toner.

□ In the case of printing brochures and other media where higher quality is required, try to print in 300 dpi or 600 dpi mode. This will result in higher-quality prints. In the case of high-quality printing (as on photo quality paper), a 1200 dpi mode is also available on some laser printers, which will consume the most toner but also produce the best-looking results.

□ If you're suffering from smudged prints, worry not. It's usually a matter of cleaning the roller, which tends to pick up some residue toner on the outside. Clean this off with a clean cloth or paper, and remember to dispose of the cloth or paper carefully. Also be careful not to come in physical contact with the toner compound—it is toxic.



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